

SNIPPETS

Solar Semiconductors starts PV export

Solar Semiconductor has started shipping solar photovoltaic modules manufactured at its facilities in Fab city. "The first consignment of PV modules was headed to Germany via Mumbai," said S.S.N. Prasad, director at Solar Semiconductor.

MindTree to split

MindTree has decided to restructure its business into five independent business units under different CEOs as it looks to rapidly expand each of these segments. The five units are IT, product engineering (which include R&D and outsource product development), testing, infrastructure management and technical support, and knowledge services.

Samsung slashes product prices by 1.7 per cent

Samsung has slashed the prices of its products by 1 to 1.7 per cent to pass on the benefit of two per cent cut in excise duty to consumers. The company has reduced the prices of its high-end LCD TVs by 1.2-1.7 per cent, while the price reduction for plasma TVs is between Rs 1000 and Rs 2000, which could vary according to the model.

LG to create 2200 jobs in 2009

Despite the economic slowdown, LG Electronics India has decided to create 2200 new jobs this year. The new jobs are planned to boost the company's R&D, sales and after-sales service infrastructure in India. While LG plans to create nearly 2000 blue-collar jobs for its service network, the balance 200-odd recruitments will be absorbed in sales and R&D functions.

RFS opens manufacturing plant in Kolkata

Radio Frequency Systems (RFS), a global wireless solutions group, has opened a new manufacturing plant in Kolkata, India, for its microwave antenna systems. The plant will enable RFS to meet the burgeoning requirement across India and later the APAC region for microwave connectivity in mobile backhaul and transmission backbone applications.

Samtel to set up JV with Thales

Delhi-based Samtel Display Systems is forming a joint venture (JV) with the French defence equipment manufacturer, Thales SA, for manufacturing defence equipment. Thales will have 26 per cent equity stake in the JV. The proposed JV will develop, manufacture and sell helmet-mounted sight displays in India for Ministry of Defence and also render after-sales services.

National Semiconductor buys Act Solar

National Semiconductor, which creates energy-efficient analogue and mixed-signal semiconductors, has acquired Act Solar, Inc., a privately held solar energy company that provides power optimisation solutions for commercial and utility-scale solar installations. The acquisition has allowed National to expand its portfolio of power optimisation technologies with new diagnostics and panel monitoring capabilities for solar arrays.

sents 13.2 per cent of LG Display's issued share capital, or 47.2 million of common stock, and reduces Philips' holding to zero.

LG Electronics and the Dutch company had formed the joint venture LG.Philips LCD Co. in 1999. Philips gradually reduced its shareholding and in March of last year the company changed its name to LG Display to

reflect the reduction.

Microchip acquires HI-TECH

Microchip Technology has acquired HI-TECH Software, a provider of development tools for embedded systems based in Brisbane, Australia. Best known for its high-performance ANSI 'C' compilers, HI-TECH Software has been a third-party provider of 'C'

compilers for Microchip's 8-, 16- and 32-bit PIC microcontrollers (MCUs) and dsPIC digital signal controllers for over a decade.

"With the addition of the HI-TECH Software portfolio, Microchip now offers a complete suite of highly efficient compilers supporting all Microchip devices, from the smallest 8-bit PIC10 MCU to the largest 32-bit PIC32 MCU," said Derek Carlson, vice president, development tools, Microchip.

The HI-TECH acquisition also extends Microchip's leadership in compiler technology by providing users with the option to develop their 'C' code using the Mac OS X and Linux operating systems.

Epson leads 3LCD projectors market globally

Epson has again won global recognition for its sales of 3-Chip liquid crystal display (3LCD) projectors from Future-source Consulting—a research firm for the projector market worldwide. Epson is now, for eight consecutive years (2001 to 2008), the global leader in projector sales. Its worldwide market share in digital projectors has grown from 17.61 per cent in 2007 to a commanding 20.62 per cent.

In South and Southeast Asia, Epson 3LCD projectors lead the market with 15.2 per cent share of a highly fragmented market of more than 30 competing brands. In India too, Epson is the market leader as per internal company estimates.

Nokia to cut another 1700 jobs worldwide

As part of a major cost-cutting drive, Finnish mobile phone maker Nokia plans to cut another 1700 jobs worldwide. These job cuts would have minimal impact on the company's India operations, with around 700 of the jobs likely to disappear in Finland. Nokia had recently called for 1000 employees worldwide to consider voluntary redundancy package.

As of Dec. 31, 2008, Nokia had 128,445 employees worldwide. In India, it has about 10,000 employees.

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